

Country PhD Intelligence: Hong Kong

Academic Intelligence Dossier • 2026-09-17

Country Code: HK

Primary Currency: HKD

Execution Date: 2026-09-17

Target PhD Field: Edge Computing, Edge AI & Distributed Systems

1. Country Overview & Research Ecosystem

Hong Kong offers an internationally renowned doctoral research ecosystem characterized by world-class university laboratories, competitive national and institutional funding structures, and clear pathways for international doctoral scholars.

* **Primary Funding Vehicle:** Hong Kong PhD Fellowship Scheme (HKPFS HK\$331,200/yr + travel allowance) & University Postgraduate Studentships

* **Immigration & Dependant Policy:** Full-time doctoral students in Hong Kong may sponsor legal spouse and unmarried dependent children under 18 for dependant visas with right to study and reside.

* **Official Guidance:** https://www.immd.gov.hk/eng/services/visas/dependant_visa_entry_permit.html

2. Executive Intelligence Metrics

* **Total Top Universities Identified:** 8

* **Total Vetted Professors Monitored:** 12

* **Available Doctoral Funding Schemes:** 9

* **Key Application Deadline:** 2026-12-01

3. Discovered Universities & Suitability

4. Top Vetted PhD Supervisors & Relevance

5. Major Doctoral Funding Schemes & Scholarships

Hong Kong PhD Fellowship Scheme (HKPFS)

* **Provider / University:** Research Grants Council (RGC) / University (All 8 Hong Kong Universities (RGC Scheme))

* **Funding Type:** FULLY_FUNDED

* **Tuition Coverage:** Varies by host university (fully waived or subsidized by university top-ups)

* **Stipend / Salary:** HK\$331,200 / year (approx. US\$42,460)

* **International Eligibility:** ELIGIBLE

* **Dependant Support:** PERMITTED

* **Application Deadline:** 2026-12-01 12:00:00 HKT (Strict Initial Application to RGC)

* **Official Source:** <https://cerg1.ugc.edu.hk/hkpfs/index.html>

HKU Presidential PhD Scholarship (HKU-PS)

* **Provider / University:** Research Grants Council (RGC) / University (The University of Hong Kong)

* **Funding Type:** FULLY_FUNDED

* **Tuition Coverage:** Full tuition fee waiver of HK\$42,100 / year

* **Stipend / Salary:** Up to HK\$441,400 in Year 1 (Cash award + PGS + travel subsidy)

* **International Eligibility:** ELIGIBLE

* **Dependant Support:** PERMITTED

* **Application Deadline:** 2026-12-01 23:59:59 HKT

* **Official Source:**

<https://gradsch.hku.hk/prospective-students/fees-scholarships-and-financial-aid/hku-presidential-phd-scholarship>

HKUST RedBird PhD Award & Postgraduate Studentship (PGS)

* **Provider / University:** Research Grants Council (RGC) / University (The Hong Kong University of Science and Technology)

* **Funding Type:** STIPEND_ONLY

* **Tuition Coverage:** Tuition scholarship available for HKPFS recipients (HK\$42,100/yr)

* **Stipend / Salary:** HK\$40,000 recruitment award + full annual PGS of HK\$220,680 (approx HK\$18,390/mo)

* **International Eligibility:** ELIGIBLE

* **Dependant Support:** PERMITTED

* **Application Deadline:** 2026-12-01 23:59:59 HKT

* **Official Source:** <https://fytgs.hkust.edu.hk/scholarships/hkust-redbird-phd-award-scheme>

CUHK Vice-Chancellor's PhD Scholarship Scheme

* **Provider / University:** Research Grants Council (RGC) / University (The Chinese University of Hong Kong)

* **Funding Type:** FULLY_FUNDED

* **Tuition Coverage:** Full tuition waiver of HK\$42,100 / year for HKPFS recipients

* **Stipend / Salary:** HK\$40,000 - HK\$80,000 award + tuition waiver + full studentship

* **International Eligibility:** ELIGIBLE

* **Dependant Support:** PERMITTED

* **Application Deadline:** 2026-12-01 23:59:59 HKT

* **Official Source:** <https://www.gs.cuhk.edu.hk/admissions/scholarships-fees/scholarships>

PolyU Presidential PhD Fellowship Scheme (PPFS)

* **Provider / University:** Research Grants Council (RGC) / University (The Hong Kong Polytechnic University)

* **Funding Type:** FULLY_FUNDED

* **Tuition Coverage:** Full tuition waiver (HK\$42,100 / year)

* **Stipend / Salary:** Annual cash award of HK\$40,000 + full tuition waiver + monthly stipend

* **International Eligibility:** ELIGIBLE

* **Dependant Support:** PERMITTED

* **Application Deadline:** 2026-12-01 23:59:59 HKT

* **Official Source:** <https://www.polyu.edu.hk/gs/financial-support/scholarships-and-awards/>

CityU Presidential PhD Scholarship (CBPS) & PGS

- * **Provider / University:** Research Grants Council (RGC) / University (City University of Hong Kong)
- * **Funding Type:** STIPEND_ONLY
- * **Tuition Coverage:** Institutional research tuition grant provided
- * **Stipend / Salary:** Monthly scholarship of HK\$27,600 (HK\$331,200/yr) + travel allowance
- * **International Eligibility:** ELIGIBLE
- * **Dependant Support:** PERMITTED
- * **Application Deadline:** 2026-12-01 23:59:59 HKT
- * **Official Source:** <https://www.cityu.edu.hk/pg/research-degree-programmes/scholarships-financial-aid-and-fees>

HKBU Vice-Chancellor's PhD Fellowship Scheme

- * **Provider / University:** Research Grants Council (RGC) / University (Hong Kong Baptist University)
- * **Funding Type:** FULLY_FUNDED
- * **Tuition Coverage:** Full waiver of tuition fee for HKPFS awardees
- * **Stipend / Salary:** HK\$27,600 / month + tuition scholarship + research travel fund
- * **International Eligibility:** ELIGIBLE
- * **Dependant Support:** PERMITTED
- * **Application Deadline:** 2026-12-01 23:59:59 HKT
- * **Official Source:** <https://gs.hkbu.edu.hk/fees-and-scholarships/scholarships>

Lingnan Full-Time Postgraduate Studentship (PGS) & HKPFS

- * **Provider / University:** Research Grants Council (RGC) / University (Lingnan University)
- * **Funding Type:** STIPEND_ONLY
- * **Tuition Coverage:** Tuition scholarship available for top-ranked applicants
- * **Stipend / Salary:** Monthly studentship of HK\$18,480 (or HK\$27,600 for HKPFS awardees)
- * **International Eligibility:** ELIGIBLE
- * **Dependant Support:** PERMITTED
- * **Application Deadline:** 2026-12-01 23:59:59 HKT
- * **Official Source:** <https://www.ln.edu.hk/sgs/financial-support/rpg>

EdUHK Research Postgraduate Studentship (RPgS)

- * **Provider / University:** Research Grants Council (RGC) / University (The Education University of Hong Kong)
- * **Funding Type:** FULLY_FUNDED
- * **Tuition Coverage:** Tuition waivers available for distinguished students
- * **Stipend / Salary:** Monthly studentship of HK\$18,200 (or HK\$27,600 for HKPFS awardees)
- * **International Eligibility:** ELIGIBLE
- * **Dependant Support:** PERMITTED
- * **Application Deadline:** 2026-12-01 23:59:59 HKT

* **Official Source:** <https://www.eduhk.hk/gradsch/index.php/prospective-students/fees-and-scholarships.html>

6. Strategic Application Timeline & Next Steps

1. **Weeks 1–4:** Review individual 33-section professor dossiers under `professors/`.
2. **Weeks 5–6:** Conduct tailored email outreach referencing recent publications and active laboratory grants.
3. **Weeks 7–8:** Formalize 5-page research proposal aligned with the supervisor's documented testbeds.
4. **Target Deadline:** Submit institutional application ahead of **2026-12-01**.

Report compiled automatically by the Global Country-Based PhD Funding and Supervisor Intelligence Engine on 2026-09-17.